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Global Macro Commentary | Global

October 29: December Chills

US rates sell off as Powell pushes back on expectations for December cut; hawkish dissent from Fed's Schmid; Fed to end QT on December 1; Canadian rates also sell off on hawkish BoC cut; Japanese & European rates range-bound ahead of BoJ & ECB; DXY at 99.22 (+0.6%); US 10y at 4.077 (+10.0bp).

Rates bear-flatten, the dollar strengthens, and equities trade sideways as market participants perceive Fed Chair Powell's speech as hawkish.

Developed Markets

- As expected, the Fed cuts by 25bp, but a dissent from Kansas City Fed President Schmid in favor of holding rates steady comes as a hawkish surprise.** On the other hand, market participants largely look through another dissent from Governor Miran in favor of 50bp, which was widely expected. Treasury yields were already higher going into the meeting and rise further after Schmid's dissent. The curve ultimately bear-flattens, with 2y Treasuries selling off 11bp and 30y yields up 9bp. The dollar strengthens (DXY: +0.6%) in line with higher yields while the S&P 500 pares gains to close unchanged.
- The bulk of the sell-off comes after Chair Powell says "a further reduction in the policy rate at the December meeting is not a foregone conclusion, far from it."** The implied probability of a December cut falls from a near certainty to roughly 60%, and pricing for January and March of 2026 falls to about 40%. In the press conference, Powell notes "strongly differing views about how to proceed in December," adding that "going forward is a different thing" from the prior two rate cuts, which he characterized as risk management. Our economists still expect a 25bps in December — for more, see [October FOMC Quick Reaction: End of QT and Dissents](#).
- Meanwhile, the Fed announces that QT will end on December 1, slightly sooner than our expectations.** With the conclusion of QT comes new details on the Fed asset reinvestment strategy, wherein all MBS proceeds will be reinvested into bills, roughly in line with our agency MBS strategists' [expectations](#). This reinvestment strategy — which translates to more front-end demand for Treasuries — in addition to our expectation that implied funding will move lower in November along with the TGA, keeps our rates strategists constructive on front-end swap spreads.
- CAD outperforms the G10, holding steady against USD following a similarly hawkish cut from BoC.** The [statement](#) notes that if the Canadian economy evolves in line with the BoC's projections, it "sees the current policy

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rate at about the right level." As a result, Canadian rates sell off in roughly equal measure to US Treasuries, leading USD/CAD to close unchanged. Our economists [expected](#) the BoC to be even more hawkish and remain on hold in October, and they maintain their outlook for no rate change in December. After CAD, AUD stores the fewest losses against USD (AUD/USD: -0.2%) following an upside surprise in September inflation (3.5% y/y; C: 3.0%).

- In the Asia session, Japanese rates slightly twist flattened on mixed policy signals following Tuesday's [US-Japan summit](#), but remained range-bound ahead of the Fed and BoJ meetings.** In the Tokyo morning, medium- and long-end JGBs underperformed after US Treasury Secretary Bessent [emphasized](#) the importance of the new government's "willingness to allow the BoJ policy space." JPY initially strengthened on Bessent's remarks and continued trade optimism, but USD/JPY retraced to end the New York session 0.4% higher at ~152.7. Long-end rates recovered throughout the session as concerns for an expansionary fiscal package moderated. Our economists expect the BoJ to remain on hold at its meeting on Thursday, with a largely unchanged price outlook. For more, see [BoJ October MPM Preview: Watching Whether Governor's Cautious Stance Will Ease Somewhat](#).
- Euro area rates close unchanged ahead of Thursday's ECB meeting, which we expect to have little impact on the rates market.** In the near term, we believe market movements are more likely to be driven by data surprises relative to consensus. EGB spreads tighten, led by OAT-Bund at ~1.5bp, with BTP-Bund following suit. Italy is expected to issue a new 10-year bond tomorrow—previously anticipated for Q3—with maturity set for February 2036. For our views on the ECB meeting, see [ECB Preview: Last Postcard from the Good Place](#).
- LatAm currencies see mixed performance, with some markets closing ahead of the FOMC decision.** MXN underperforms after the meeting, weakening 0.2% against USD despite the lack of local headlines. Mexico's TIE sells off alongside US rates with a steepening bias. Brazil's DI curve mildly bull-steepens, with the short end rallying 2bp despite a long-end sell-off. Colombia and Chile outperform regional currencies, rallying 0.6-0.8%, with the latter supported by a 1.5% increase in copper prices. However, both FX markets closed before the Fed decision, implying a potential retracing upon market open on Thursday.

Central Bank Monitor

Developed Markets

- The **Fed** lowered the target federal funds range by 25bp to 3.75–4.0% and announced that balance sheet runoff will end on December

1, with agency principal payments reinvested into Treasury bills. The FOMC statement upgraded its characterization of growth, but not as much as it might have, and maintained an easing bias. We continue to expect another 25bp cut in December. [Read more](#)

- **Fed Chair Powell**, in addition to the comments discussed above, noted a "growing chorus" who believe the Fed "should at least wait a cycle" before continuing cuts. Powell also said that the Fed does not "see the weakness...in the job market accelerating," despite recent announcements of corporate layoffs.
- The **Bank of Canada** lowered its policy rate from 2.50% to 2.25%, despite our economists' expectation for BoC to remain on hold. Our economists maintain their view that the BoC will stay on hold at the December meeting, barring any sudden surprises in the labor and inflation data.
- **ECB President Lagarde** [reiterated](#) calls for the EU to make more decisions by majority vote, as the current system gives individual states too much veto power.

Emerging Markets

- **RBI Deputy Governor Gupta** [reiterated](#) that the exchange rate is largely driven by market forces but cautioned against excessive volatility, arguing that allowing a completely free-floating currency does not necessarily yield better outcomes than the practices followed in less developed markets. Gupta also highlighted that India's near-term growth prospects remain strong, with several high-frequency indicators signaling robust expansion in the second half of FY26. She reiterated the central bank's view that there is room for further monetary policy easing.

Exhibit 1: G4 Rates Closes (5pm NY)

Tenor	US			Germany			UK			Japan		
	29-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	29-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	29-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	29-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
2y	3.598	10.8		1.972	0.0		3.761	(0.6)		0.940	0.7	
3y	3.598	10.1		2.028	0.0		3.749	(0.3)		1.009	0.9	
5y	3.711	10.2		2.231	(0.1)		3.871	0.0		1.223	1.0	
7y	3.884	11.0		2.364	(0.2)		4.001	(0.4)		1.438	0.9	
10y	4.076	10.0		2.620	(0.2)		4.391	(0.8)		1.648	1.0	
20y	4.603	8.8		3.088	(0.2)		5.049	(0.9)		2.575	(0.3)	
30y	4.625	8.5		3.187	(0.3)		5.163	(1.0)		3.045	(0.9)	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Inflation Closes (5pm NY)

US TIPS				10y Real Yields, BEI			
Tenor	29-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk	10y	29-Oct	1d Δ (bp)	2wk
5y	1.328	10.0		DBRi	0.674	0.3	
BEI	2.376	0.3		BEI	1.742	(0.6)	
10y	1.774	9.2		UKTi	1.547	0.8	
BEI	2.299	0.8		BEI	2.912	(1.7)	
30y	2.396	8.0		JGBi	0.042	(0.2)	
BEI	2.232	0.6		BEI	1.576	1.2	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 3: Macro Closes (5pm NY)

Majors				EM				Equities / Commodities			
Spot	29-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk	Spot	29-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk	Index	29-Oct	1d Δ (%)	2wk
DXY	99.22	0.6		CNH	7.10	0.0		S&P	6890.59	(0.0)	
EUR	1.160	(0.4)		INR	88.20	(0.1)		Stoxx	5705.81	0.0	
GBP	1.319	(0.6)		THB	32.27	(0.6)		FTSE	9756.14	0.6	
JPY	152.73	0.4		KRW	1421.10	(0.8)		Nikkei	51307.65	2.2	
CHF	0.800	0.8		ZAR	17.20	0.3		VIX	16.92	3.0	
AUD	0.657	(0.2)		MXN	18.48	0.3		Gold (S)	3930.07	(0.6)	
CAD	1.394	(0.0)		BRL	5.36	0.1		WTI (Fut)	60.48	0.5	

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 4: G4 Central Bank Implied Pricing

Central Bank OIS											
Fed	Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	ECB	Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ	BOE	Implied	1d Δ (bp)	Total Δ
EFFR (10/28)	4.120	0.0	—	EONIA (10/28)	1.930	0.0	—	SONIA (10/28)	3.969	0.0	—
12/10/25	3.710	8.9	(41.0)	10/30/25	1.927	0.1	(0.3)	11/06/25	3.904	1.1	(6.6)
01/28/26	3.618	12.5	(50.2)	12/18/25	1.909	(0.1)	(2.1)	12/18/25	3.805	0.8	(16.4)
03/18/26	3.529	14.7	(59.1)	02/05/26	1.895	(0.0)	(3.5)	02/05/26	3.649	0.3	(32.0)
04/29/26	3.463	14.3	(65.7)	03/19/26	1.854	0.2	(7.6)	03/19/26	3.583	0.3	(38.7)
06/17/26	3.316	12.8	(80.4)	04/30/26	1.837	(1.1)	(9.3)	04/30/26	3.469	(0.5)	(50.0)
07/29/26	3.230	11.8	(89.0)	06/11/26	1.832	2.8	(9.8)	06/11/26	3.436	(0.6)	(53.3)

Source: Morgan Stanley Research, Bloomberg

Economic Releases*Developed Markets*

- **US September Pending Home Sales:** 0.0% m/m (C: 1.2%; P: 4%). Pending sales of existing US homes stalled in September, as job market concerns kept buyers on the sidelines despite easing mortgage rates.
- **Spain 3Q Flash GDP:** 0.6% q/q (MSe: 0.6%; C: 0.7%; P: 0.8%)
- **Belgium 3Q Flash GDP:** 0.3% (MSe: 0.2%; P: 0.2%)
- **Sweden Preliminary 3Q GDP:** 1.1% q/q (MSe: 0.5%; C: 0.7%; P: 0.5%) & **Monthly GDP Indicator:** -0.1% (MSe: 0.0%; P: 1.1%). This is a very strong print, confirming the Riksbank is done with easing. However, the September slowdown is notable and October data will be key to understanding momentum.
- **Australia September CPI:** 3.5% y/y (MSe: 2.9%; C: 3.0%; P: 2.1%). Electricity remains a large headline driver, but rising services and construction inflation are more important contributors to the lift in core measures.

Emerging Markets

- **Korea September Retail Sales:** 7.7% y/y (P: 3.7%); **Department Store Sales:** 4.8% y/y (P: 2.8%); **Discount Store Sales:** -11.7% y/y (P: -15.6%)
- **Chile September Unemployment Rate:** 8.5% (P: 8.6%; C: 8.5%). Chile's unemployment rate came in line with expectations, easing slightly from 8.6% in August and 8.7% a year ago. The steady decline in the unemployment rate

over the past year points to gradual labor market normalization, though the pace remains slow.

The Day Ahead

Developed Markets

- **BoJ Monetary Policy:** Our economists expect the BoJ to largely maintain the status quo. They expect the economic outlook in the Outlook Report to be revised up to reflect the current assessment of the US economy, while the price outlook likely remains unchanged from the previous report. Board Member Takata's recent positive assessments of overseas economies may reflect in the remarks and Outlook Report. [Read more](#)
- **ECB Monetary Policy:** Our economists expect the ECB to remain on hold and adhere to its "good place" economic narrative. The communication should remain unchanged, stressing data dependency and meeting-by-meeting approach. [Read more](#)
- 6:30am BST - **France 3Q Flash GDP** (MSe: 0.1% q/q; C: 0.2%; P: 0.3%)
- 8:00am BST - **Spain October Flash CPI** (MSe: 3% m/m; C: 2.9%; P: 3%)
- 8:00am BST - **Italy 3Q Flash GDP** (MSe: -0.1% q/q; C: 0.1%; P: -0.1%)
- 8:00am CET - **Sweden September Retail Sales** (MSe: 0.3% m/m; P: -0.9%). We expect retail sales to increase only slightly in September due to weaker consumer spending intentions, though NIER survey data showed improved trade volumes.
- 8:55am BST - **Germany October Unemployment Rate** (MSe: 6.4%; C: 6.3%; P: 6.3%)
- 9:00am BST - **Germany 3Q Flash GDP** (MSe: 0.2% q/q; C: 0%; P: -0.3%)
- 9:30am BST - **Portugal 3Q Flash GDP** (MSe: 0.6% q/q; P: 0.6%)
- 10:00am BST - **Euro Area September Unemployment Rate** (MSe: 6.3%; C: 6.3%; P: 6.3%)
- 10:00am BST - **Euro Area October Economic Confidence** (MSe: 95.9; C: 95.8; P: 95.5)
- 10:00am BST - **Euro Area 3Q Flash GDP** (MSe: 0.1%; C: 0.1%; P: 0.1%)
- 10:00am BST - **Italy September Unemployment Rate** (MSe: 6.0%; C: 6.0%; P: 6.0%)
- 11:30am BST - **Belgium October Flash CPI** (MSe: 2% q/q; P: 2.1%)
- 1:00pm BST - **Germany October Flash CPI** (MSe: 2.2%; C: 2.2%; P: 2.4%)
- 8:30am EST - **US October Initial Jobless Claims** (MSe: 225k ; C: 229k;). National claims data are not being published, but we construct

totals from state reports. We estimate initial claims rose to 232k for the week of Oct 18, up 12k from the prior week, though most of the increase should reverse. Claims remain near recent averages and do not indicate rising layoffs. Continuing claims edged up to 1.941 million, still within the recent range.

- 1:15pm EST - **Dallas Fed President Logan** will speak at the Bank Funding Conference

Emerging Markets

- Thu 9:00am HKT - **Philippines September Trade Balance** (C: -\$4.3bn; P: -\$3.5bn); **Exports** (C: 11.4% y/y; P: 4.6%) and **Imports** (C: -2.3% y/y; P: -4.9%)
- 10:30am HKT - **Singapore September Unemployment Rate** (C: 2.0%; P: 2.1%)
- 8:00am EST - **Mexico 3Q P GDP SA** (MSe: 0.5% y/y; P: 0.0%; C: -0.3%). Consensus expects a mild contraction, while our economists [forecast](#) a modest rebound after Q2 stagnation. A stronger-than-expected outcome could reinforce a cautious stance on rate cuts, while a downside miss may support further easing. Markets are pricing ~41bps of cuts through year-end and ~32bps in 2026, implying a terminal rate near 6.77% by March.

For more details, please refer to our economists' weekly reports and data previews:

- [US](#)
- [Japan](#)
- [Europe](#)
- [Asia/Pacific](#)
- [LatAm](#)
- [CEEMEA](#)

Please [click here](#) if you would like to receive our weekly strategic advice on global rates, FX, and EM. See our latest [Global Macro Strategist: It Ain't What You Don't Know That Gets You Into Trouble...](#) and recent publications:

- US Public Policy: [Thinking Through the USMCA Review](#)
- US Rates Strategy: [November US Treasury Refunding Preview](#)
- Chile Economics and Strategy: [Central Bank Review - A Cautious Data-Dependent Stance](#)

G4 Smarter (Beta) Trading Partners

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Since 2000, enhancements to a G4 10y government bond futures momentum strategy have produced higher Sharpe ratios and stronger returns relative to total return government bond indices for the G4: US, Germany, Japan, and the UK. See [A "Smarter" \(Beta\) Way to Trade G4 10y Futures Duration?](#) for more information on these strategies.

Exhibit 5: Trading Signals for G4 Smarter (beta) Trading Strategy

Current Risk, G4 10y Futures	G4 Strategy Weight	Trade Longs Portfolio	Fade Shorts Portfolio	Total Risk Trade Longs Only	Total Risk Trade Longs/Fade Shorts (max 200%)	Trade Longs Portfolio Entry Date	Trade Longs Portfolio Exit Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Entry Date	Fade Shorts Portfolio Exit Date
J8 10y Future	32.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/20/2025	9/19/2025	10/28/2025
GE 10y Future	29.25%	100%	0%	100%	100%	10/7/2025	11/11/2025	-	-
US 10y Future	30.50%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/14/2025	11/19/2025	9/24/2025	10/30/2025
UK 10y Future	7.75%	100%	100%	100%	200%	10/15/2025	11/19/2025	9/25/2025	10/30/2025

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Trading Strategy 1 – "Trade Longs/Fade Shorts"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract and hold for a 25-business-day period. In short, this strategy buys futures when the Simple Moving Average Crossover (SMAX) generates both a long and a short signal, given the historical outperformance of long signals traded long and the underperformance of short signals traded short. Given that the SMAX could generate both a long and a short signal within the predefined holding period, an investor may have a 200% long position since each of the two signals would be traded in separate portfolio sleeves.

Trading Strategy 2 – Trade "Longs Only"

When the 5-day moving average crosses above the 20-day moving average, buy the futures contract (long duration) and hold for a 25-business-day period. When the 5-day moving average crosses below the 20-day moving average, do nothing. In short, an investor *only* trades long signals initiated by the SMAX given their historical precedent to outperform.

US Holiday Trading Strategy

Currently Active Strategies

None.

Combining the individual trading signals based on 10y Treasury future (TY) price patterns before and after US holidays has generated an annual strategy with no down years since 1987. See [Trading 10y Treasury Futures Around US Holidays](#) for more information.

Using historical data since 1983, we created a trading strategy using 10y Treasury futures (TY) that trades 11 times per year, either long or short, before or after the following US holidays: New Year's Day, Martin Luther King Day, Presidents' Day, Good Friday, Memorial Day, Independence Day, Labor Day, Columbus Day, Thanksgiving, and Christmas. [Exhibit 6](#) displays the trading rules:

Exhibit 6: Trading rules for US holiday trading model using US 10y futures contracts (TY)

Holiday	Day of Week	Direction	Before/After Holiday	Trading Rule (business days, 3pm NY unless specified)	Trade Entry (business days)	Trade Exit (business days)
New Year's Day	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY New Years +1, Sell TY New Years +4	New Year + 1	New Year + 4
Martin Luther King Day 1	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Tuesday before MLK, Sell Friday before MLK	MLK - 4	MLK - 1
Martin Luther King Day 2	Monday	Short TY	After	Sell TY Tuesday after MLK, Buy Friday after MLK	MLK + 1	MLK + 4
President's Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Pres. Day, Sell TY Friday after Pres. Day	Pres. Day + 1	Pres. Day + 4
Good Friday	Friday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Monday after Good Friday, Sell TY Friday after Good Friday	Good Friday + 1	Good Friday + 5
Memorial Day	Monday	Long TY	After	Buy TY Tuesday after Mem. Day, Sell TY Friday after Mem. Day	Mem. Day + 1	Mem. Day + 4
Independence Day (July 4th)	Rotates	Long TY	After	Buy TY Independence Day + 2, Sell TY Independence Day + 4	Ind. Day + 2	Ind. Day + 4
Labor Day	Monday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Monday before Labor Day, Sell TY Thursday before Labor Day	Labor Day - 4	Labor Day - 2
Columbus Day	Monday	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Monday before Col. Day, Buy TY Thursday before Col. Day	Colum. Day - 5	Colum. Day - 2
Thanksgiving	Thursday	Long TY	Before	Buy TY Friday before Thanksgiving, Sell TY Tuesday before Thanksgiving	Thanksgiving - 4	Thanksgiving - 2
Christmas	Rotates	Short TY	Before	Sell TY Christmas Day - 4, Buy TY Christmas Day - 1	Christmas - 4	Christmas - 1

Source: Morgan Stanley Research. Note: Past performance is no guarantee of future results.

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(as of September 30, 2025)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1499	41%	389	46%	26%	702	41%
Equal-weight/Hold	1618	44%	375	44%	23%	782	45%
Not-Rated/Hold	4	0%	1	0%	25%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	577	16%	88	10%	15%	234	14%
Total	3,698		853			1719	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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